Patrick E. McKnight, Ph.D.

Associate Professor of Psychology | George Mason University

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Google Scholar | ORCID | GMU Profile

Personal Statement

I am a social scientist whose interests largely focus on human motivation and performance. My purpose in life is to contribute to the scientific body of knowledge by studying individuals in their natural performance environments (a la Brunswikian representative design) and measuring them with the best possible tools. That purpose guides me as a scientist, father, adventurer, and citizen. I am an unabashed proponent of quantitative methods, both frequentist and subjectivist, using the most sophisticated, open-source tools to achieve my goals. My work to date and research interests are best explored on my Google Scholar, personal, and MRES lab web sites.

Education

Ph.D. in Psychology (Clinical), University of Arizona, 1997 - *Dissertation: Calibration of Psychological Measures: An illustration of three quantitative calibration procedures. Chair: Lee Sechrest, Ph.D.*

M.S. in Exercise and Sports Sciences, University of Arizona, 1992 - *Thesis: The effects of cohesion and identifiability on social loafing. Chair: Jean M. Williams, Ph.D.*

B.S. in Mechanical Engineering, University of Notre Dame, 1988

Academic Positions

Associate Professor, George Mason University, Department of Psychology: Human Factors and Applied Cognition, 2011–Present

Advisory Board Member, Sense about Science USA, STATS.org, 2015–Present

Consultant, McKnight Consulting, LLC, Research and Technical Consulting, 2005–Present

Assistant Professor, George Mason University, Department of Psychology, 2005–2011

Research Assistant Professor, University of Arizona, Department of Psychology, EGAD, 2002–2005

Health Sciences Specialist, VA Puget Sound Health Care System, CESATE, 1999–2001

Psychology Resident, University of Washington, College of Medicine, Psychiatry and Behavioral Sciences, 1998–1999

Honors & Awards

2026. Nominee, George Mason University Teaching Excellence Award (full-time faculty) — Stearns Center for Teaching and Learning

Books

McKnight, P.E., McKnight, K.M., Sidani, S. & Figueredo, A.J. (2007). *Missing Data: A Gentle Introduction*. New York: Guilford Press. *[1,502 citations]*

Bootzin, R.R. & McKnight, P.E. (Eds) (2006). *Strengthening Research Methodology: Psychological Measurement and Evaluation*. Washington: American Psychological Association. *[34 citations]*

Book Chapters

- Kashdan, T.B., McKnight, P.E., & Gross, M. (2026). The curiosity inefficiency model: An essential part of the creative person, process, and products. In Holinger, M., Ruch, W., Tay, L., Özyaprak, M., & Kaufman, J.C. (Eds.), *The Cambridge Handbook of Creativity and Wellbeing*. Cambridge University Press (in press).
- McKnight, P.E. & McKnight, K.M. (2013). Missing Data in Psychological Science. In Comer, J.S. & Kendall, P.C. (Eds.), *Oxford Handbook of Research Strategies for Clinical Psychology*. Oxford University Press.
- McKnight, P.E. & McKnight, K.M. (2011). Missing data in archival research. In Trzesniewski, K.H., Donnellan, M.B., & Lucas, R.E. (Eds.), *Obtaining and Analyzing Archival Data: Methods and Illustrations*. American Psychological Association.
- McKnight, K.M. & McKnight, P.E. (2009). Measures for Improving Measures. In Streiner, D.L. & Sidani, S. (Eds.), *When Research Goes Off the Rails*. Guilford Press. *[1 citations]*
- McKnight, P.E., McKnight, K.M., & Figueredo, A.J. (2005). The nature of a scientific legacy: The case study of Lee Sechrest. In Bootzin, R. & McKnight, P.E. (Eds.), *Strengthening Research Methodology: Psychological Measurement and Evaluation*. American Psychological Association.
- Wilhelm, O. & McKnight, P.E. (2002). Ability and achievement testing on the World Wide Web. In Batinic, B., Reips, U.D., & Bosnjak, M. (Eds.), *Online Social Sciences*. Hogrefe & Hubers. *[45 citations]*
- Wilhelm, O., Witthöft, M., McKnight, P.E., & Grössler, A. (1999). On the psychometric quality of new ability tests administered using the WWW. In Reips, U.-D. (Eds.), *Current Internet Science — Trends, Techniques, Results*. Online Press, Zürich.
- Sechrest, L., Davis, M.F., Stickle, T.R., & McKnight, P.E. (1999). Understanding 'method' variance. In Bickman, L. (Eds.), *Research Design: Donald Campbell's Legacy*. Sage Publications.

Journal Articles

93 peer-reviewed articles

2026

- Kashdan, T.B., McKnight, P.E., & Harrison, S.H. (2026). Curiosity at work: A productive inefficiency model. *Annual Review of Organizational Psychology and Organizational Behavior*. doi:10.1146/annurev-orgpsych-012825-104832
- Kashdan, T.B., & McKnight, P.E. (2026). Prejudice against jagged personality profiles: Rethinking bias in psychological research and clinical practice. *Current Opinion in Psychology*, *70*, 102290. doi:10.1016/j.copsyc.2026.102290

- McKnight, P.E., Kashdan, T.B., MacKay, A., Kelso, K., & Gross, M. (2026). Purpose and happiness: A comparison. *Journal of Positive Psychology*, *21*(4), 658-669. doi:10.1080/17439760.2025.2515942 *[1 citations]*

2025

- Kashdan, T.B., McKnight, P.E., Kelso, K., Craig, L., & Gross, M. (2025). Enhancing curiosity with a wise intervention to improve political conversations and relationships. *Scientific Reports*, *15*(1), 40272. doi:10.1038/s41598-025-24021-8 *[2 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., McKnight, P.E., Kelso, K., Craig, L., Guenoun, B., & Naughton, C. (2025). Multiple dimensions of workplace curiosity: Evidence of generalizability in nine countries. *Personality and Individual Differences*. doi:10.1016/j.paid.2024.113011 *[5 citations]*
- Blanco-Donoso, L.M., Torio, L., Hernández-Hurtado, M., Lecuona, O., Carmona-Cobo, I., Kashdan, T.B., McKnight, P.E., & Garrosa, E. (2025). Spanish adaptation of the Multidimensional Workplace Curiosity Scale. *Acta Psychologica*, *258*, 105140. doi:10.1016/j.actpsy.2025.105140

2024

- Kaufman, J., Kashdan, T.B., & McKnight, P.E. (2024). Past glories feel good but creative minorities push us forward. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, *47*, e183. doi:10.1017/s0140525x24000773
- Jackson, K.M., Thayer, S.C., Simpson, K.L., Shaw, T.H., McKnight, P.E., & Helton, W.S. (2024). Swimming with a head-mounted display: dual-task costs. *Ergonomics*, 1-10. doi:10.1080/00140139.2024.2339436 *[1 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Kaufman, J.C., & McKnight, P.E. (2024). The costs of curiosity and creativity: Minimizing the downsides while maximizing the upsides. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, *47*, e105. doi:10.1017/s0140525x23003539 *[1 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Goodman, F.R., McKnight, P.E., Brown, B.A., & Rum, R. (2024). Purpose in life: A resolution on the definition, conceptual model, and optimal measurement. *American Psychologist*, *79*(6), 838-853. doi:10.1037/amp0001223 *[75 citations]*
- Harwood, A.E., Satterfield, K., Helton, W.S., McKnight, P.E., & Shaw, T.H. (2024). The Role of State and Trait Self-Control on the Sustained Attention to Response Task. *Human Factors*. doi:10.1177/00187208231209151 *[6 citations]*

2023

- Dang, J.A., Shaw, T.H., McKnight, P.E., & Helton, W.S. (2023). A closer look at warning cues on the sustained attention to response task performance. *Human Factors*, *65*(8), 1793-1803. doi:10.1177/00187208211060708 *[10 citations]*

2022

- Lockhart, P.B., Thornhill, M.H., Zhao, J., et al. & McKnight, P.E. (2022). Factors that affect dentists' use of antibiotic prophylaxis. *Journal of the American Dental Association*. doi:10.1016/j.adaj.2021.11.010 *[14 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., McKnight, P.E., & Goodman, F.R. (2022). Evolving positive psychology: A blueprint for advancing the study of purpose in life, psychological strengths, and resilience. *Journal of Positive Psychology*, *17*(2), 210-218. doi:10.1080/17439760.2021.2016906 *[32 citations]*

2021

- McKnight, P.E., Kidd, J.K., Gallington, D.A., Strauss, L.I., Lyu, H., Gadzichowski, K.M., & Pasnak, R. (2021). The Efficacy of Teaching Advanced Forms of Patterning to Kindergartners. *Creative Education*, *12*(03), 557. doi:10.4236/ce.2021.123038 *[7 citations]*

2020

- Mougeot, J.L.C., Davis, J.M., Zhao, J., Sullivan, K.A., Thornhill, M.H., McKnight, P.E., Stephens, C., & Lockhart, P.B. (2020). Methodology for the development of a national Dental Practice-Based Research Network survey on dentist's beliefs and behaviors concerning antibiotic prophylaxis. *Oral Surgery, Oral Medicine, Oral Pathology and Oral Radiology*. doi:10.1016/j.oooo.2020.03.004 *[3 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Disabato, D.J., Goodman, F.R., & McKnight, P.E. (2020). The Five-Dimensional Curiosity Scale Revised (5DCR): Briefer subscales while separating overt and covert social curiosity. *Personality and Individual Differences*, *157*, 109836. doi:10.1016/j.paid.2020.109836 *[306 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Goodman, F.R., Disabato, D.J., McKnight, P.E., Kelso, K., & Naughton, C. (2020). Curiosity has comprehensive benefits in the workplace. *Personality and Individual Differences*, *155*, 109717. doi:10.1016/j.paid.2019.109717 *[168 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Disabato, D.J., Goodman, F.R., Doorley, J.D., & McKnight, P.E. (2020). Understanding psychological flexibility: A multimethod exploration of pursuing valued goals despite the presence of distress. *Psychological Assessment*, *32*(9), 829. doi:10.1037/pas0000834 *[388 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Disabato, D.J., McKnight, P.E., Kelso, K.C., Lauber, M., & Goodman, F.R. (2020). Sexual assault: Exploring real-time consequences the next day and in subsequent days. *International Journal of Wellbeing*, *10*(4). doi:10.5502/ijw.v10i4.1319 *[3 citations]*
- Gonçalves, S.F., Chaplin, T.M., López Jr, R., et al. & McKnight, P.E. (2020). High-Frequency Heart Rate Variability and Emotion-Driven Impulse Control Difficulties During Adolescence. *Journal of Early Adolescence*. doi:10.1177/0272431620983453 *[8 citations]*
- Lockhart, P.B., Thornhill, M.H., Zhao, J., et al. & McKnight, P.E. (2020). Prophylactic antibiotic prescribing in dental practice. *Journal of the American Dental Association*, *151*(10), 770-781. doi:10.1016/j.adaj.2020.04.027 *[24 citations]*

2019

- Schnyer, R.N., McKnight, P., Conboy, L.A., Jacobson, E., Ledegza, A.T., Quilty, M.T., Davis, R.B., & Wayne, P.M. (2019). Can Reliability of the Chinese Medicine Diagnostic Process Be Improved? Results of a Prospective Randomized Controlled Trial. *Journal of Alternative and Complementary Medicine*. doi:10.1089/acm.2019.0260 *[11 citations]*
- Jacobson, E., Conboy, L., Tsering, D., Shields, M., McKnight, P., Wayne, P.M., & Schnyer, R. (2019). Experimental Studies of Inter-Rater Agreement in Traditional Chinese Medicine: A Systematic Review. *Journal of Alternative and Complementary Medicine*. doi:10.1089/acm.2019.0197 *[33 citations]*
- Brailo, V., McKnight, P., Kerr, A.R., Lodi, G., & Lockhart, P.B. (2019). World Workshop on Oral Medicine VII: What participants perceive as important. *Oral Diseases*. doi:10.1111/odi.13091 *[1 citations]*
- Doorley, J.D., Kashdan, T.B., Alexander, L.A., Blalock, D.V., & McKnight, P.E. (2019). Distress tolerance in romantic relationships: A daily diary exploration with methodological considerations. *Motivation and Emotion*, *43*(3), 505-516. doi:10.1007/s11031-019-09751-3 *[62 citations]*

- Fontana, M., Eckert, G.J., Keels, M.A., et al. & McKnight, P. (2019). Predicting Caries in Medical Settings: Risk Factors in Diverse Infant Groups. *Journal of Dental Research*, *98*(1), 68-76. doi:10.1177/0022034518799080 *[24 citations]*
- Curby, T., McKnight, P., Alexander, L., & Erchov, S. (2019). Sources of variance in end-of-course student evaluations. *Assessment & Evaluation in Higher Education*. doi:10.1080/02602938.2019.1607249 *[23 citations]*

2018

- Blalock, D.V., Kashdan, T.B., & McKnight, P.E. (2018). High risk, high reward: Daily perceptions of social challenge and performance in social anxiety disorder. *Journal of Anxiety Disorders*. doi:10.1016/j.janxdis.2018.01.006 *[14 citations]*
- Blalock, D.V., McKnight, P.E., Kashdan, T.B., & Franz, S.C. (2018). Predicting treatment course and outcome using a promotion and prevention framework in a community sample of arthritis sufferers. *Patient Preference and Adherence*. doi:10.2147/ppa.s161144 *[2 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Stiksma, M.C., Disabato, D.D., McKnight, P.E., Bekier, J., Kaji, J., & Lazarus, R. (2018). The five-dimensional curiosity scale: Capturing the bandwidth of curiosity and identifying four unique subgroups of curious people. *Journal of Research in Personality*, *73*, 130-149. doi:10.1016/j.jrp.2017.11.011 *[713 citations]*
- Yarbro, J.L., & McKnight, P.E. (2018). An introduction to cost-effectiveness acceptability curves. *Clinical Practice in Pediatric Psychology*, *6*(2), 179. doi:10.1037/cpp0000243 *[1 citations]*
- Bock, A.M., Cartwright, K.B., McKnight, P.E., et al. & Pasnak, R. (2018). Patterning, reading, and executive functions. *Frontiers in Psychology*, *9*, 1802. doi:10.3389/fpsyg.2018.01802 *[52 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Blalock, D.V., Young, K.C., Machell, K.A., Monfort, S.S., McKnight, P.E., & Ferssizidis, P. (2018). Personality Strengths in Romantic relationships. *Psychological Assessment*. doi:10.1037/pas0000464 *[114 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Goodman, F.R., Stiksma, M., Milius, C.R., & McKnight, P.E. (2018). Sexuality Leads to Boosts in Mood and Meaning in Life. *Emotion*. doi:10.1037/emo0000324 *[109 citations]*

2017

- Alexander, L.A., McKnight, P.E., Disabato, D.J., & Kashdan, T.B. (2017). When and How to use Multiple Informants to Improve Clinical Assessments. *Journal of Psychopathology and Behavioral Assessment*. doi:10.1007/s10862-017-9607-9 *[61 citations]*
- Monfort, S.S., Graybeal, J.J., Harwood, A.E., McKnight, P.E., & Shaw, T.H. (2017). A single-item assessment for remaining mental resources: development and validation of the Gas Tank Questionnaire. *Theoretical Issues in Ergonomics Science*. doi:10.1080/1463922x.2017.1397228 *[35 citations]*
- Bono, G., Froh, J.J., Disabato, D., Blalock, D., McKnight, P., & Bausert, S. (2017). Gratitude's role in adolescent antisocial and prosocial behavior: A 4-year longitudinal investigation. *Journal of Positive Psychology*. doi:10.1080/17439760.2017.1402078 *[141 citations]*

2016

- de Visser, E.J., Monfort, S.S., McKendrick, R., Smith, M.A.B., McKnight, P.E., Krueger, F., & Parasuraman, R. (2016). Almost Human: Anthropomorphism Increases Trust Resilience in Cognitive Agents. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Applied*. doi:10.1037/xap0000092 *[955 citations]*

- Foroughi, C.K., Monfort, S.S., Paczynski, M., McKnight, P.E., & Greenwood, P.M. (2016). Placebo effects in cognitive training. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, *113*(27), 7470-7474. doi:10.1073/pnas.1601243113 *[325 citations]*
- Saad, M.A., McKnight, P., Quartuccio, J., Nicholas, D., Jaladi, R., & Corriveau, P. (2016). Online subjective testing for consumer-photo quality evaluation. *Journal of Electronic Imaging*, *25*(4), 043009. doi:10.1117/1.jei.25.4.043009 *[5 citations]*
- McKnight, P.E., Monfort, S.S., Kashdan, T.B., Blalock, D.V., & Calton, J.M. (2016). Anxiety Symptoms and Functional Impairment: A Systematic Review of the Correlation between the Two Measures. *Clinical Psychology Review*, *45*, 115-130. doi:10.1016/j.cpr.2015.10.005 *[203 citations]*

2015

- Cowan, A., Sarabia-Estrada, R., Wilkerson, G., Mcknight, P., & Guarnieri, M. (2015). Lack of adverse effects during a target animal safety trial of extended-release buprenorphine in fischer 344 rats. *Lab Animal*. doi:10.1038/laban.745 *[13 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Feldman-Barrett, L., & McKnight, P.E. (2015). Unpacking emotion differentiation: Transforming unpleasant experience by perceiving distinctions in negativity. *Current Directions in Psychological Science*, *24*(1), 10-16. doi:10.1177/0963721414550708 *[797 citations]*
- Shaw, T.H., Nguyen, C., Satterfield, K., Ramirez, R., & McKnight, P.E. (2015). Cerebral hemovelocity reveals differential resource allocation strategies for extraverts and introverts during vigilance. *Experimental Brain Research*, *234*(2). doi:10.1007/s00221-015-4481-8 *[21 citations]*
- Sattler, D.N., McKnight, P.E., Naney, L., & Mathis, R. (2015). Grant peer review: Improving inter-rater reliability with training. *PLoS One*, *10*(6), e0130450. doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0130450 *[97 citations]*
- Young, K.C., Kashdan, T.B., McKnight, P.E., Blalock, D.V., Yuen, M., & Richberg, J.B. (2015). Happy and unhappy adolescent bullies: Evidence for theoretically meaningful subgroups. *Personality and Individual Differences*, *75*, 224-228. doi:10.1016/j.paid.2014.11.024 *[21 citations]*

2014

- Graybeal, J.J., Bozzelli, P.L., Graybeal, L.L., Groeber, C.M., McKnight, P.E., Cox, D.N., & Flinn, J.M. (2014). Human ApoE ε4 Alters Circadian Rhythm Activity, IL-1β, and GFAP in CRND8 Mice. *Journal of Alzheimer's Disease*, *43*(3), 823-834. doi:10.3233/jad-132009 *[48 citations]*
- VanDerhei, S., Rojahn, J., Stuewig, J., & McKnight, P.E. (2014). The Effect of Shame-Proneness, Guilt-Proneness, and Internalizing Tendencies on Nonsuicidal Self-Injury. *Suicide and Life-Threatening Behavior*, *44*(3), 317-330. doi:10.1111/sltb.12069 *[92 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Adams, L.M., Farmer, A.S., Ferssizidis, P., McKnight, P.E., & Nezlek, J.B. (2014). Sexual healing: Daily diary investigation of the benefits of intimate and pleasurable sexual activity in socially anxious adults. *Archives of Sexual Behavior*, *43*(7), 1417-1429. doi:10.1007/s10508-013-0171-4 *[45 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Yarbro, J., McKnight, P.E., & Nezlek, J.B. (2014). Laughter with someone else leads to future social rewards: Temporal change using experience sampling methodology. *Personality and Individual Differences*, *58*, 15-19. doi:10.1016/j.paid.2013.09.025 *[80 citations]*
- Yarbro, J., Arfstrom, K.M., McKnight, K., & McKnight, P. (2014). Extension of a review of flipped learning. *Flipped Learning Network*. *[450 citations]*

- Kidd, J.K., Pasnak, R., Gadzichowski, K.M., Gallington, D.A., McKnight, P., Boyer, C.E., & Carlson, A. (2014). Instructing first-grade children on patterning improves reading and mathematics. *Early Education & Development*, *25*(1), 134-151. doi:10.1080/10409289.2013.794448 *[125 citations]*

2013

- Kashdan, T.B., & McKnight, P.E. (2013). Commitment to a purpose in life: An antidote to the suffering by individuals with social anxiety disorder. *Emotion*, *13*(6), 1150. doi:10.1037/a0033278 *[178 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Farmer, A.S., Adams, L.M., Ferssizidis, P., McKnight, P.E., & Nezlek, J.B. (2013). Distinguishing healthy adults from people with social anxiety disorder. *Journal of Abnormal Psychology*, *122*(3), 645. doi:10.1037/a0032733 *[270 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Ferssizidis, P., Farmer, A.S., Adams, L.M., & McKnight, P.E. (2013). Failure to capitalize on sharing good news with romantic partners. *Behaviour Research and Therapy*, *51*(10), 656-668. doi:10.1016/j.brat.2013.04.006 *[103 citations]*

2012

- Kashdan, T.B., Young, K.C., & McKnight, P.E. (2012). When is rumination an adaptive mood repair strategy?. *Journal of Anxiety Disorders*, *26*(7), 762-768. doi:10.1016/j.janxdis.2012.07.004 *[34 citations]*
- Voelkle, M.C. & McKnight, P.E. (2012). One size fits all? A Monte-Carlo simulation on repeated measures (M)ANOVA and latent curve modeling. *Methodology*, *8*, 23-38. doi:10.1027/1614-2241/a000044 *[1 citations]*

2011

- Thompson, J.C., Trafton, J.G., & McKnight, P. (2011). The perception of humanness from the movements of synthetic agents. *Perception*, *40*, 695-704. doi:10.1068/p6900 *[99 citations]*
- Renshaw, K.D., McKnight, P., Caska, C.M., & Blais, R.K. (2011). The utility of the relationship assessment scale in multiple types of relationships. *Journal of Social and Personal Relationships*, *28*, 435-447. doi:10.1177/0265407510377850 *[146 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., Adams, L., Savostyanova, A., Ferssizidis, P., McKnight, P.E., & Nezlek, J.B. (2011). Effects of social anxiety and depressive symptoms on the frequency and quality of sexual activity. *Behaviour Research and Therapy*, *49*, 352-360. doi:10.1016/j.brat.2011.03.004 *[130 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., & McKnight, P.E. (2011). Dynamic, contextual approaches to studying personality in the social world. *Journal of Personality*, *79*, 1177-1190. doi:10.1111/j.1467-6494.2011.00737.x *[18 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., McKnight, P.E., Fincham, F.D., & Rose, P. (2011). When curiosity breeds intimacy. *Journal of Personality*, *79*, 1369-1401. doi:10.1111/j.1467-6494.2010.00697.x *[157 citations]*
- McKnight, P.E., Johns, M.J., McGovern, P.J., & Najab, J. (2011). The pitfalls of a tool-based science and the promise of a problem-focused science. *Journal of Methods and Measurement in the Social Sciences*, *1*, 1-14. doi:10.2458/jmm.v1i2.99 *[2 citations]*

2010

- Kashdan, T.B. & McKnight, P.E. (2010). The darker side of social anxiety. *Current Directions in Psychological Science*, *19*(1), 47-50. doi:10.1177/0963721409359280 *[179 citations]*
- Farr, J., Going, S., McKnight, P.E., Kasle, S., Cussler, E., & Cornette, M. (2010). Progressive resistance training improves overall physical activity levels in patients with early osteoarthritis of the knee. *Physical Therapy*, *90*, 356-366. doi:10.2522/ptj.20090041 *[153 citations]*

- Kasle, S., Wilhelm, M.S., McKnight, P.E., Sheikh, S.Z., & Zautra, A.J. (2010). Mutuality's prospective beneficial effect on inflammation in female rheumatoid arthritis patients. *Arthritis Care & Research*, *62*(1), 92-100. doi:10.1002/acr.20019 *[45 citations]*
- McKnight, P.E., Kasle, S., Going, S., Villanueva, I., Cornett, M., Farr, J., Wright, J., Streeter, C., & Zautra, A. (2010). A comparison of strength training, self-management, and the combination for early osteoarthritis of the knee. *Arthritis Care & Research*, *62*(1), 45-53. doi:10.1002/acr.20013 *[147 citations]*
- McKnight, P.E., Afram, A., Kashdan, T.B., Kasle, S., & Zautra, A. (2010). Coping self-efficacy as a mediator between catastrophizing and physical functioning. *Journal of Behavioral Medicine*, *33*, 239-249. doi:10.1007/s10865-010-9252-1 *[61 citations]*

2009

- Kashdan, T.B., & McKnight, P.E. (2009). Origins of purpose in life: Refining our understanding of a life well lived. *Psihologijske Teme. [351 citations]*
- Hofmann, S.G., Richey, J.A., Kashdan, T.B., & McKnight, P.E. (2009). Anxiety disorders moderate the association between externalizing problems and substance use disorders. *Journal of Anxiety Disorders*, *23*(4), 529-534. doi:10.1016/j.janxdis.2008.10.011 *[66 citations]*
- Kashdan, T.B., McKnight, P.E., Richey, J.A., & Hofmann, S.G. (2009). When social anxiety disorder co-exists with risk-prone, approach behavior. *Behaviour Research and Therapy*, *47*(7), 559-568. doi:10.1016/j.brat.2009.03.010 *[157 citations]*
- McKnight, P.E. & Kashdan, T.B. (2009). The importance of functional impairment to mental health outcomes. *Clinical Psychology Review*, *29*(3), 243-259. doi:10.1016/j.cpr.2009.01.005 *[530 citations]*
- McKnight, P.E. & Kashdan, T.B. (2009). Purpose in life as a system that creates and sustains health and well-being. *Review of General Psychology*, *13*(3), 242-251. doi:10.1037/a0017152 *[1608 citations]*

2007

- McKnight, P. & Babcock-Parziale, J. (2007). Respondent impact on functional ability outcome measures in vision rehabilitation. *Optometry and Vision Sciences*, *84*(8), 721-728. doi:10.1097/opx.0b013e31812f756f *[6 citations]*

2006

- Coan, J.A., Allen, J.J., & McKnight, P.E. (2006). A capability model of individual differences in frontal EEG asymmetry. *Biological Psychology*, *72*(2), 198-207. doi:10.1016/j.biopsycho.2005.10.003 *[494 citations]*
- Caspi, O., McKnight, P., Kruse, L., Cunningham, V., Figueredo, A.J., & Sechrest, L. (2006). Evidence-based medicine: discrepancy between perceived competence and actual performance among graduating medical students. *Medical Teacher*, *28*(4), 318-325. doi:10.1080/01421590600624422 *[87 citations]*

2005

- Babcock-Parziale, J., McKnight, P.E. & Head, D.N. (2005). Evaluating the psychometric properties of a clinical and a self-report blind rehabilitation outcome measure. *Journal of Rehabilitation Research and Development*, *42*(4), 487-498. doi:10.1682/jrrd.2004.07.0080 *[45 citations]*
- McKnight, K.M., Sechrest, L., & McKnight, P.E. (2005). Psychology, psychologists, and public policy. *Annual Review of Clinical Psychology*, *1*, 557-576. doi:10.1146/annurev.clinpsy.1.102803.144130 *[38 citations]*

- Bayles, K.A., Kim, E.S., Azuma, T., et al. & McKnight, P. (2005). Developing Evidence-Based Practice Guidelines for Speech-Language Pathologists Serving Individuals with Alzheimer's Dementia. *Journal of Medical Speech-Language Pathology*, *13*(4), xiii-xxv. *[33 citations]*
- Schnyer, R., Conboy, L., Jacobson, E., McKnight, P., et al. (2005). Development of a Chinese Medicine Assessment Measure: An Interdisciplinary Approach using the Delphi Method. *Journal of Complementary and Alternative Medicine*, *11*(6), 1005-1013. doi:10.1089/acm.2005.11.1005 *[67 citations]*

2004

- Stroud, M., McKnight, P.E. & Jensen, M. (2004). Assessment of Self-Reported Physical Activity in Chronic Pain Patients: Development of an Abbreviated Roland-Morris Disability Scale. *Journal of Pain*, *5*(5), 257-263. doi:10.1016/j.jpain.2004.04.002 *[185 citations]*
- Conrad, K.J., Wright, B.D. & McKnight, P.E. (2004). Comparing Traditional and Rasch Analyses of the Mississippi PTSD Scale. *Journal of Applied Measurement*, *5*(1), 15-30. *[82 citations]*
- Bayles, K.A., Tomoeda, C.K., McKnight, P.E., Helm-Estabrooks, N., & Hawley, J.N. (2004). Verbal perseveration in individuals with Alzheimer's disease. *Seminars in Speech and Language*, *25*(4), 335-347. doi:10.1055/s-2004-837246 *[57 citations]*

2003

- McKnight, P.E. & Sechrest, L. (2003). The use and misuse of the term 'experience' in contemporary psychology. *Philosophical Psychology*, *16*(3), 431-460. doi:10.1080/0951508032000121814 *[27 citations]*
- Reed, R.L., Hepburn, K., Adelson, R., Center, B., & McKnight, P. (2003). Low serum albumin levels, confusion and fecal incontinence: Are these risk factors for pressure ulcers?. *Gerontology*, *49*(4), 255-259. doi:10.1159/000070407 *[144 citations]*
- Doctor, J.N., Wolfson, A.M., McKnight, P.E. & Burns, S.P. (2003). The effect of inaccurate FIM instrument ratings on prospective payment. *Archives of Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation*, *84*(1), 46-50. doi:10.1053/apmr.2003.50063 *[9 citations]*

2002

- Schmaling, K.B., McKnight, P.E. & Afari, N. (2002). A prospective daily study of the relationship of moods and stress to pulmonary function among patients with asthma. *Journal of Asthma*, *39*(6), 501-510. doi:10.1081/jas-120004916 *[125 citations]*

2001

- Baer, J.S., Kivlahan, D.R., Blume, A., McKnight, P.E., & Marlatt, G.A. (2001). Brief intervention for heavy drinking college students: Four-year follow-up and natural history. *American Journal of Public Health*, *91*(8), 1310-1316. doi:10.2105/ajph.91.8.1310 *[1450 citations]*

2000

- Figueredo, A.J., McKnight, P.E., McKnight, K.M. & Sidani, S. (2000). Multivariate modeling of missing data within and across assessment waves. *Addiction*, *95*(Suppl 3), 361-380. doi:10.1046/j.1360-0443.95.11s3.6.x *[152 citations]*

1999

- Reed, R.L., Hepburn, K., Adelson, R., Center, B., & McKnight, P.E. (1999). Risk factors for development of stage 2 or greater pressure ulcers in hospitalized older adults. *Journal of the American Geriatrics Society*, *47*(9), S4.

1996

- Sechrest, L., McKnight, P., & McKnight, K. (1996). Calibration of measures for psychotherapy outcome studies. *American Psychologist*, *51*(10), 1065-1071. doi:10.1037/0003-066x.51.10.1065 *[219 citations]*
- Erickson, J.R., Stevens, S., McKnight, P.E., & Figueredo, A.J. (1996). Willingness for treatment as a predictor of retention and outcomes. *Journal of Addictive Diseases*, *14*(4), 135-150. doi:10.1300/j069v14n04_08 *[78 citations]*

Conference Proceedings

- Saad, M.A., McKnight, P.E., Quartuccio, J., Nicholas, D., Jaladi, R., & Corriveau, P. (2016). Consumer-photo quality assessment: Challenges and pitfalls in crowdsourcing. *2016 Eighth International Conference on Quality of Multimedia Experience (QoMEX).*
- Quartuccio, J., Franz, S., Gonzalez, C., Kenner, N., Cades, D.M., Sala, J.B., Arndt, S.R., & McKnight, P.E. (2014). Seeing is believing: The use of data visualization to identify trends for cycling safety. *Human Factors and Ergonomics Society Annual Meeting Proceedings.*
- de Visser, E., Krueger, F., McKnight, P.E., Scheid, S., Smith, M., Chalk, S., & Parasuraman, R. (2012). The world is not enough: Trust in cognitive agents. *Human Factors and Ergonomics Society Annual Meeting Proceedings.*
- Kasle, S., McKnight, P.E., Sheikh, S.Z., Swe, K., Lisse, J.R., Wilhelm, M.S., & Zautra, A.J. (2008). DMARD use, marital satisfaction, and inflammation in RA. *Arthritis and Rheumatism, 58(9, Suppl.), S871.*
- Kasle, S., Sheikh, S.Z., McKnight, P.E., Swe, K., Lisse, J.R., Wilhelm, M.S., & Zautra, A.J. (2008). Mutuality protects against inflammation in rheumatoid arthritis patients. *Arthritis and Rheumatism, 58(9, Suppl.), S209.*
- Algotar, A.M., Martinez, E.M., McKnight, P.E., Heigh, R.I., & Lance, P. (2005). Results of a survey to assess colorectal cancer screening capacity in Arizona. *American Journal of Epidemiology, 161(11, Suppl.), S131.*
- Chen, M.K., & McKnight, P.E. (2004). Confirmatory factor analysis in measurement development: A model comparison between CFA and classical test theory. *International Journal of Psychology, 39(5–6, Suppl.), 66.*
- McKnight, P.E., & Chen, M.K. (2004). Evaluating measurement models. *International Journal of Psychology, 39(5–6, Suppl.), 66.*
- Fridel, K.W., Cousins, J.C., McKnight, P.E., & Bootzin, R.R. (2004). A multitrait-multimethod analysis of sleep log and actigraphy assessment in adolescents recovering from substance abuse. *Sleep, 27(Suppl.), 371–372.*
- Cam, K.M., McKnight, P.E., & Doctor, J.N. (2002). The Delphi method online: Medical expert consensus via the Internet. *Proceedings of the AMIA Symposium, 990.*
- Coan, J.A., Allen, J.J.B., & McKnight, P.E. (2002). Generalizability of trait- and state-manipulated frontal EEG asymmetry. *Psychophysiology, 39(Suppl. 1), S26.*

Manuscripts Under Review

- Gross, M.E., Kashdan, T.B., McKnight, P.E., & Schooler, J.W. (2026). Shaping personality with micro-interventions: Using curiosity as an example of state-to-trait personality change. *American Psychologist.* [2-year JIF = 16.4]

- Hershmati, R., Kashdan, T.B., McKnight, P.E., Farsani, M.A., & Esfandi, M.R. (2026). The nature of emotion regulation in Iran. *Under review.*

Preprints & Working Papers

- Kashdan, T.B., McKnight, P.E., Gross, M., & Schooler, J.W (2026). Happiness and Purpose in Life: Overlapping Self-Regulatory Traits in a Two-Year Longitudinal Study. *SSRN preprint.* doi:10.2139/ssrn.6442491
- Simpson, R., Cowden, R.G., Psimopoulos, C., Lomas, T., Moore, M., Ashfield, A., VanderWeele, T.J., Kashdan, T.B., & McKnight, P.E (2026). Sport for Flourishing: Challenges, Considerations, and Calls to Action. *PsyArXiv preprint.* doi:10.31234/osf.io/szh4a_v2

Software

- **GradStats-Book** — A free, open, continuously maintained online graduate statistics textbook, with all code kept current against present software versions. https://pem725.github.io/GradStats-Book/
- **Social Science Measurement Project** — An open-source project for developing and freely distributing software to analyze social science measures. http://ssm.sf.net/
- **Delphi Online Project** — An open-source project producing software to conduct online Delphi studies. http://delphionline.sf.net/
- **Statistics Courseware** — An open-source educational package that randomly assigns datasets to students for exams and quizzes, administers quizzes online with timed access, and provides immediate feedback.
- **MRES R package** — An open-source R package of data-reduction routines commonly used in measurement research.

Research Funding

Total Funding: $6,985,060

A Smartphone-Based Program for Enhancing Curiosity and Its Associated Virtues (PI: Todd Kashdan)
John Templeton Foundation | Co-Investigator — $94,854 | 2025–2028

An Internet of Things Automated Cognitive Behavioral Therapy for Insomnia that Improves Cognition in Older Adults (PI: Daniel Gartenberg)
NIH / National Institute on Aging (R43AG097205-01, SBIR Phase I; awarded to Proactive Life Inc. d/b/a SleepSpace) | Analytic Lead | 2025–2026

The Well-Being Laboratory (PI: Todd Kashdan)
Charles Koch Foundation | Co-Investigator | 2023–2026

Predicting Caries Lesion Patterns and Trajectories in Underserved Children, from Infancy to Early Adolescence, in Primary Healthcare Settings (PI: Margherita Fontana)
University of Michigan School of Dentistry (NIDCR-funded multi-site cohort; PAF 22-PAF07272) | Consultant | 2021–present

Crowdsourcing forecast models in intelligence (PI: Georghe Tecuci)
IARPA | Co-Investigator | 2016–2021

Distinguishing extraordinarily happy from psychologically flexible people (PI: Todd Kashdan)
Koch Foundation | Co-Investigator — $248,000 | 2016–2021

Evaluation and Review of ONR Immersive Training Environments
Office of Naval Research (ONR) | Principal Investigator — $899,577 | 2014–2016

Diagnosis and prediction of mild traumatic brain injury (PI: Judith Babcock-Parziale)
VA Health Services Research and Development | Co-Investigator | 2009–2012

Advancing Outcomes Measurement and Micro-costing in Blind Rehabilitation
VA Health Services Research and Development | Co-Investigator — $550,080 | 2006–2010

Trait and State Frontal Brain Asymmetry in Depression
NIH-NIMH | Co-Investigator — $1,869,813 | 2004–2009

Multidimensional Intervention in Osteoarthritis
NIAMS | Co-Investigator — $2,630,000 | 2003–2007

Comprehensive Plan to Insure Capacity for Screening and Early Detection of Colorectal Cancer in Arizona
Arizona Department of Health Services | Co-Investigator — $275,000 | 2004–2006

Positive Mental Health and Outcomes in Osteoarthritis
Arthritis Foundation | Co-Investigator — $313,500 | 2002–2006

Tucson Energy Baseline Study
Department of Energy / TMEC | Principal Investigator — $19,000 | 2001–2002

Calibration of Measures for Assessing Low-Vision Rehabilitation Patients
VA Rehabilitation Research and Development | Co-Investigator — $85,236 | 2001–2003

Teaching

Graduate Courses

- **PSYC 611**: Introductory Statistics and Methods I
- **PSYC 612**: Introductory Statistics and Methods II
- **PSYC 642**: General Linear Modeling I
- **PSYC 643**: General Linear Modeling II
- **PSYC 754**: Multiple Regression
- **PSYC 757**: Bayesian Data Analysis
- **PSYC 734**: Measurement & Study of Peak Performance

Undergraduate Courses

- **PSYC 301**: Introductory Statistics
- **PSYC 325**: Psychopathology
- **PSYC 405**: Mystery, Madness, and Murder (Mason Core)

Doctoral Students

Current Students

- Amrote Getu
- Kristin Carpenter
- Dan Singer
- Spencer Vilim
- Maya Chrishawn Jones
- Ansley Booth

Completed (18)

- Dean Cisler, George Mason University, 2024
- Kara Massick, George Mason University, 2024
- Amanda Harwood, George Mason University, 2020
- Michael Waltrip, George Mason University, 2020
- Lisa Alexander, George Mason University, 2019
- Max Shear, George Mason University, 2018
- Simone Erchov, George Mason University, 2017
- Jake Quartuccio, George Mason University, 2017
- Sam Monfort, George Mason University, 2017
- John Graybeal, George Mason University, 2016
- Dan Blalock, George Mason University, 2016
- Jessica Yarbro, George Mason University, 2016
- Julius Najab, George Mason University, 2013
- Mei Kuang Chen, University of Arizona, 2008
- Michael Menke, University of Arizona, 2005
- Kim Bissel, University of Arizona, 2001
- Richard Lane, University of Arizona, 2000
- Opher Caspi, University of Arizona, 2000

Professional Affiliations

- American Evaluation Association, 1991–Present — Chair, Quantitative Methods TIG (2001-present)
- American Statistical Association, 1997–Present
- Association for Psychological Science, 1992–Present
- Psychometric Society, 1997–Present
- Society for the Science of Clinical Psychology, 1992–Present
- American Association for the Advancement of Science, 2001–Present
- American Psychological Association - Division 5, 2009–Present
- Society for Judgment and Decision Making, 2010–Present

Technical Skills

Statistical Software: R, SAS, SPSS, Python, Stan, JAGS, Julia

SEM/IRT: lavaan, Mplus, EQS, LISREL, Onyx, Mx, mirt, ltm, Winsteps, Multilog, Bilog

Programming: R, Python, C/C++, Fortran, Julia, SQL, LaTeX, Quarto, Shiny

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Scholarly Impact

Metric	Value
Total Citations	16,616
h-index	52
i10-index	80
Publications	91+

Source: Google Scholar, 2026-07-23

Beyond Academia

Mountaineering: Everest (2018), Aconcagua (2017), Denali (2011)

Marathon Swimming: English Channel, Catalina Channel, 20 Bridges Manhattan

- Triple Crown of Marathon Swimming - Fastest Known Time (34 days)
- Ranked Top 50 Most Adventurous Open Water Swimmers
- 10th Member of Peak & Pond Club (2018)

Triathlon: Canadian Ironman (10:03)

Erdos Number: 6

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